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Green Tea – Health Benefits Summary

Introduction

Green tea *Camelliasinensis* is widely studied for its potential health-promoting properties. This two-page summary synthesizes findings from three reputable sources: Cleveland Clinic, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health, and Healthline.

- **Cardiovascular Health:** Regular consumption is linked to lower LDL cholesterol and reduced risk of heart disease.
- **Metabolic Effects:** May improve insulin sensitivity and help lower blood glucose, supporting diabetes prevention.
- **Cancer Prevention:** Contains catechins *especially EGCG* that exhibit anti-inflammatory and anti-cancer activities.
- **Neuroprotection:** Antioxidants may protect brain cells, potentially reducing the risk of cognitive decline.
- **Weight Management:** modest increase in metabolic rate and fat oxidation.

Key Benefits *Harvard*

- **Antioxidant Power:** Polyphenols *catechins* neutralize free radicals, decreasing oxidative stress.
- **Heart Disease Risk Reduction:** Associated with modest reductions in blood pressure and arterial stiffness.
- **Bone Health:** Some studies suggest improved bone mineral density with regular intake.
- **Gut Microbiome:** Polyphenols may promote beneficial gut bacteria, influencing overall health.

Key Benefits *Healthline*

- **Skin Health:** EGCG may protect against UV-induced damage and improve skin elasticity.
- **Mental Alertness:** Moderate caffeine combined with L-theanine supports focus without jitteriness.
- **Longevity:** Epidemiological data indicate regular drinkers have lower all-cause mortality rates.
- **Immune Support:** Antimicrobial properties may bolster immune defenses.

Conclusion

Across multiple high-quality sources, green tea consistently shows benefits for cardiovascular health, metabolic regulation, cancer risk mitigation, neuroprotection, and overall longevity. Regular moderate consumption *2-3 cups/day* appears safe for most adults, though excessive intake may cause insomnia or interact with certain medications.

Sources: Cleveland Clinic health.clevelandclinic.org, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health hsph.harvard.edu, Healthline healthline.com.